

Agricultural Science Farm Placement

Science

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Agricultural Science Farm Placement (A07892)

Short Title: Agri Science Farm Placement
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Science
Cluster Placement and Projects
Author SWALSH
Credits 30

Level: Intermediate

Description of Module / Aims

This module is designed to give the student experience of practical farming on a high quality farm. The placement aims to allow learners to apply and develop their knowledge and skills. The farm placement is organised by Teagasc, and the student will be placed on a mixed farm enterprise in order to gain a broad experience of farming. The student will be monitored by the host farmer, by Teagasc staff, and the student will also keep a reflective work log. The completion of this work log will develop the student's ability to engage in reflective learning. Students are also encouraged to seek placements overseas, e.g. New Zealand, UK.

Programmes

AGRI -0096 BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (WD_SAGRI_B)

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Indicative Content

- Placement requirements: a minimum of 15 weeks on a host farm organised by Teagasc; the student will be punctual, use safe working practices, avail of learning opportunities
- Performance of work: work output and quality, dependability, performing tasks in accordance with directions, using initiative, adaptability and apply theory to practice
- Relating, communicating and working with co-workers/team members, or with the host farmer and family members, and with people who do business with the farmer
- Record of placement experience (reflective work log): particulars of features of the host farm, inventory of machinery, livestock movements, enterprise details, duties carried out and end of placement summary
- Maintenance of a work log of placement, critical evaluation and reflection on both the experience itself, as well as the professional development achieved
- Guidelines for the student, Institute and employers on the aims, objectives, and expectations of the module (learning agreement/guidelines)

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. Construct a professional CV and prepare for interview to secure placement.
2. Appraise the aims, expectations and objectives of the employer, Institute and student to the successful completion of placement.
3. Operate independently and/or as part of a team towards the set objectives of the farm enterprise and relate effectively to co-workers and host farmer family members.
4. Apply, under supervision, their agricultural knowledge and skills in the day to day planning and operations on the farm.
5. Practise safely, agriculture related skills and employ both good environmental practices and those associated with good animal health and welfare.
6. Appraise, reflect and report on personal, professional and technical achievements.
7. Communicate their activities and assessment of the farm enterprise in a professional manner.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Practical learning experience from a host farmer.
- Working and relating with other farm workers as well as the host farm family.
- Practical learning experience of health and safety on a farm.
- Maintain a daily diary.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Continuous Assessment	100%	
<i>Portfolio</i>	Pass/Fail	1,2,3,4,5,6,7,

Assessment Criteria

Fail: Student fails to undertake or complete placement to a satisfactory level and/or fails to submit the assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes.

Pass: Minimum period of at least 15 weeks placement completed, satisfactory Supervisors Evaluation Report submitted, and assessments and documents related to the learning outcomes, all to an acceptable standard and submitted within deadlines.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Placement	810	

Essential Material

- Teagasc, T. *‘Notebook and Daily Diary for Farm Placement’*. Ireland: Teagasc, 2014.

Supplementary Material

- Fanthome, C. *‘Work placements : a survival guide for students’*. Basingstoke : Palgrave Macmillan, 2004.